

Anote - AI Action Plan

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Developing an AI Action Plan

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Introduction

On behalf of Anote and the Armor Institute, we are pleased to submit this response to the National Science Foundation's Request for Information (RFI) on the development of an **AI Action Plan**. Our organizations share a mission to democratize artificial intelligence (AI) and strengthen the AI workforce. Anote is a human-centered AI company that helps enterprises extract actionable insights from unstructured data, while the Armor Institute is an AI education initiative that brings hands-on learning experiences to communities across the United States. We commend the NSF's leadership in shaping a forward-looking AI strategy, and we offer the following recommendations to ensure the United States remains at the forefront of AI innovation, **ethically** and **competitively**.

AI Policy Recommendations: Accessibility, Workforce & Innovation

To foster a vibrant AI ecosystem, we advocate for policies that support broad **AI accessibility**, robust **workforce development**, and dynamic **private sector innovation**, all underpinned by balanced regulation. Key recommendations include:

- **Promote AI Accessibility and Democratization:** Federal policy should encourage the development and dissemination of AI tools that are accessible to organizations of all sizes and to underserved communities. This includes open datasets, open-source frameworks, and affordable cloud AI resources, enabling startups, small businesses, and researchers to leverage AI capabilities. By lowering barriers to entry, the NSF and other agencies can ensure that the benefits of AI are widely shared across society.
- **Invest in AI Workforce Development:** A national AI action plan must prioritize education and training programs to cultivate an AI-savvy workforce. We recommend increased support for STEM (science, technology, engineering, and mathematics) and AI curricula at all levels, grants for AI-focused university programs, and vocational training for AI skills. Workforce development initiatives should also emphasize retraining and upskilling for current workers, so that America's talent pool remains adaptable as AI transforms industries.
- **Encourage Private Sector Innovation:** The federal government should continue to fund and incentivize AI research and development in the private sector. Public-private partnerships (such as NSF innovation grants and Small Business Innovation Research programs) can accelerate breakthroughs by leveraging industry expertise. Additionally, policies like R&D tax credits and streamlined technology transfer processes will spur innovation, allowing companies like Anote to develop cutting-edge AI solutions that drive economic growth.

- **Ensure Balanced and Ethical AI Regulation:** We urge a balanced regulatory approach that safeguards security, privacy, and ethical standards without stifling innovation. Rather than one-size-fits-all regulation, a risk-based framework can set guidelines for high-risk AI applications (for example, in critical infrastructure or human safety) while permitting flexibility for low-risk uses. Collaboration between policymakers, industry leaders, and academia is crucial to develop standards and best practices—such as transparent AI systems, bias mitigation strategies, and cybersecurity protocols—that build public trust in AI. With clear guidance and guardrails, companies can innovate confidently, and society can reap AI’s benefits safely.

Advancing AI Accessibility and Workforce Development

Making AI broadly accessible and building a skilled AI workforce are central to Anote’s and the Armor Institute’s missions. **Anote’s AI solutions** illustrate how advanced technology can be made practical and beneficial for enterprises, and the **Armor Institute’s community initiatives** show the power of hands-on education:

- **Enterprise AI Made Accessible (Anote):** Today, an estimated 85% of enterprise data is unstructured (such as text documents, emails, and reports) and often underutilized. Anote’s platform addresses this challenge by using AI to rapidly classify text, extract key entities and facts, and answer complex questions from large document collections. By automating these tasks with accuracy and speed, Anote enables organizations to uncover insights that would otherwise remain hidden, improving decision-making and operational efficiency. Importantly, Anote’s human-centered approach means its AI systems learn from domain experts and end-users, ensuring the technology is intuitive and aligned with real-world needs. This approach helps businesses large and small to adopt AI solutions without needing a team of data scientists, thereby **democratizing access to AI-driven analytics**.
- **Community AI Education (Armor Institute):** The Armor Institute expands AI literacy and skills at the grassroots level. Through an expanding series of AI events, workshops, and meetups in multiple U.S. cities, the Institute provides **hands-on AI education** for students, professionals, and enthusiasts. These events demystify AI through interactive learning—participants get to experiment with AI tools, build simple models, and see AI applications in action. By bringing together AI researchers, industry practitioners, and community members, the Armor Institute’s programs foster inclusive engagement and inspire local talent. Someone in a mid-size city can attend an Armor Institute workshop and come away with tangible AI skills and a network of peers, which is critical for building an AI-ready workforce beyond the traditional tech hubs. Such

community-centric education ensures that as AI advances, opportunities to learn and contribute are available to a broad cross-section of Americans.

In combination, Anote and the Armor Institute exemplify how **accessibility** and **workforce development** go hand in hand. Technology solutions like Anote's make AI more usable and beneficial across industries, while educational outreach by the Armor Institute empowers people with the knowledge to use and create AI. We believe federal support for similar initiatives—scaling practical AI tools and community education—will multiply these impacts nationally.

Collaboration with Federal Agencies and National AI Initiatives

To fully realize the potential of AI, collaboration between government, industry, and educational organizations is essential. Anote and the Armor Institute recommend several avenues for working with federal agencies to enhance AI adoption, research, and governance:

- **Public-Private AI Adoption Initiatives:** Federal agencies can partner with AI solution providers like Anote to pilot AI applications that improve government services and operations. For example, agencies managing large archives of documents or data could collaborate with Anote to deploy natural language processing (NLP) tools that extract insights and improve public data access. Such pilot programs would not only enhance agency efficiency but also serve as case studies for AI adoption in various sectors, building confidence in AI technologies across the economy.
- **Joint Research and Funding Programs:** We encourage NSF to expand funding for applied AI research and to facilitate joint projects between academia and industry. As an AI-focused company, Anote is eager to contribute to research endeavors (for instance, in areas like NLP, human-in-the-loop learning, or AI ethics) alongside universities and national labs. Initiatives such as the NSF **National AI Research Institutes** are excellent models that could be extended or partnered with industry-led efforts. By co-funding research and innovation challenges, the government can leverage private sector agility and ensure research breakthroughs transition more rapidly into practical solutions.
- **Policy Development and Regulatory Sandboxes:** The Armor Institute and Anote are ready to share on-the-ground insights to inform effective AI policy. We suggest establishing multi-stakeholder committees or advisory councils where industry experts, researchers, and public representatives collaborate with policymakers on AI guidelines. Additionally, the government might create “regulatory sandboxes” for AI – controlled environments where companies can test new AI technologies or business models under supervision. This approach would allow regulators to learn and adapt rules in step with

technological advances, ensuring that regulations remain **adaptive, evidence-based, and supportive of innovation**.

- **AI Training and Upskilling Partnerships:** To address the nationwide demand for AI skills, federal agencies (including NSF, Department of Labor, and Department of Education) should partner with organizations that have training expertise. The Armor Institute's community workshops could be expanded or integrated into a larger government-supported program for AI upskilling. For example, a federal grant could enable free or low-cost AI bootcamps in underserved areas, delivered in collaboration with institutes like Armor. Such programs should target a diverse audience — from displaced workers seeking new career paths to public servants who need to understand AI in their roles. Government investment in these training partnerships will cultivate a larger, more inclusive pipeline of AI talent.
- **Support for Regional Innovation Hubs:** We recommend the establishment of AI innovation hubs across the country, where academia, industry, and government intersect. These hubs (potentially building on NSF's existing programs and partnering with initiatives like the Armor Institute's city-based meetups) would provide physical and virtual spaces for experimentation, mentorship, and startup incubation. By seeding regional centers of AI excellence — in areas ranging from healthcare AI to smart manufacturing — the government can stimulate local economies and ensure that AI-driven growth is distributed nationwide. Anote and similar companies can contribute by mentoring startups or providing tools and datasets for hub participants, creating a virtuous cycle of innovation and knowledge-sharing.

Conclusion: A Vision for U.S. AI Leadership

In summary, Anote and the Armor Institute strongly believe that a successful national AI Action Plan must blend **innovation-friendly policy** with **inclusive growth of skills and opportunities**. By championing accessibility, investing in the workforce, encouraging private innovation, and embracing public-private collaboration, the United States can secure its position as a global leader in AI. We envision an AI future where American enterprises of all sizes harness data for insight and productivity, where workers continually upgrade their skills for the new AI-driven jobs, and where communities across the nation participate in the AI revolution.

We appreciate the NSF's consideration of our perspective. **Anote** and the **Armor Institute** are committed to advancing these goals and stand ready to collaborate on implementing this action plan. With continued leadership and strategic investment, the U.S. can foster an AI ecosystem that is not only cutting-edge and competitive, but also ethical, inclusive, and aligned with our national values. We look forward to working together to turn this vision into reality.